

Anahita Karandikar

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Development Economics; Behavioural Economics; Gender

EDUCATION

University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada

PhD in Economics

2022 -

Ashoka University, Haryana, India

MA in Economics (cum laude)

2019

Fergusson College of Arts and Sciences, University of Pune, India

2017

BA in Economics (first class with distinction)

RESEARCH

PUBLICATIONS

Rainfall Shocks and Learning Outcomes: Dynamic Persistence and the Role of Local Labour Demand (with Aparajita Dasgupta)

Economica, 2026

Learning from Job Offers About Labor Supply Constraints (with Lisa Ho and Suhani Jalota)

AEA Papers and Proceedings, 2025

Road Access, Fertility and Child Health in Rural India (with Aparajita Dasgupta and Devvrat Raghav)

Population and Development Review, 2024

WORKING PAPERS

Bringing Work Home: Flexible Arrangements as Gateway Jobs for Women in West Bengal (with Lisa Ho and Suhani Jalota)

[Conditionally Accepted, The Quarterly Journal of Economics]

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

Richer but Stricter? The Mixed Legacy of British Colonial Army Recruitment in India

[Draft available on request]

Intra-Household Demand for Women's Autonomy: Evidence from Uttar Pradesh

[Pilot complete]

SELECTED CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2025: AEA Annual Meeting, UBC Dev/Pol Econ Lunch, Pacific Conference for Development Economics

2024: UBC Dev/Pol Econ Lunch (x 2)

2021: Delhi School of Economics Winter School

SUMMER SCHOOLS AND WORKSHOPS

RSF Behavioral Economics Camp 2026

WORK EXPERIENCE

Women in Economics and Policy (Registered as WIEP India Association)

Apr 2021 -

Director

Tasks: Team management, fundraising for a community catering to 2000+ women; Leading a mentorship and resource sharing intervention scale-up in 8 colleges in India (*funded by IEA Women in Leadership in Economics Initiative*)

Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL South Asia)

Jun 2019 - Apr 2022

Research Associate

Principal Investigators: Gautam Rao (UC Berkeley), Frank Schilbach (MIT)

*Projects: Understanding Barriers to the Take-Up of Mental Health Treatment (Scoping);
Alleviating Psychological and Economic Stress During COVID-19 (Pilot and RCT)*

Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL South Asia)

Jun - Dec 2018

Research Intern

Principal Investigators: Gautam Rao (UC Berkeley), Frank Schilbach (MIT), Johannes Haushofer (Stockholm University), Jon de Quidt (IIES, Stockholm University)

Project: The Long-Run Effects of Psychotherapy on Depression, Beliefs, and Economic Outcomes (Pilot)

TEACHING

INSTRUCTOR UBC Vancouver Summer Program: Global Economic Growth **Jul - Aug 2026**

TEACHING ASSISTANT ECON 442: Issues in Economic Development **Jan - Apr 2024, 2025 and 2026**
ECON 333: Economic History of Europe **Sept - Dec 2024**
ECON 351: Sex and Gender in the Economy **Sept - Dec 2023**
Mathematics for Economics (*Ashoka University*) **Jan - May 2018**

REFEREEING *Economic Development and Cultural Change, Economic Modelling, Oxford Economic Papers, The Quarterly Journal of Economics*

SELECTED AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS UBC Stone Centre on Wealth and Income Inequality, PhD Fellowship **2026-2027**
University of British Columbia, John Helliwell Fellowship **2025**
University of British Columbia, 4YF Doctoral Fellowship **2022-2026**
President's Academic Excellence Initiative PhD Award **2022-2025**
University of British Columbia, International Tuition Award **2022-2025**
University of British Columbia, CERC Doctoral Fellowship **2022**
University of British Columbia, R Howard Webster Foundation Fellowship **2022, 2025**
Ashoka University, Department Award for Excellent Academic Performance
(Awarded to two students with the highest CGPA from the graduating cohort of 23) **2019**

SELECTED RESEARCH GRANTS Weiss Fund Research Grant (*with Matt Lowe and Jeff Weaver*) **\$91,890**
Stone Research Grant (*with Matt Lowe and Jeff Weaver*) **CA\$24,867**
SSRC/The Alfred P. Sloan Foundation (*with Matt Lowe and Jeff Weaver*) **\$43,330**
Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics: Pilot Grant **\$10,294**
Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics: Exploratory Grant **\$4,333**
SSHRC Insights Grant (*with Matt Lowe and Jeff Weaver*) **CA\$344,089**
J-PAL Gender & Economic Agency Initiative (*with Lisa Ho*) **\$21,562**
J-PAL Jobs & Opportunities Initiative (*with Lisa Ho*) **\$46,921**
STEG Small Research Grant (*with Lisa Ho*) **£14,843**

LANGUAGES English (native) • Marathi (native) • Hindi (fluent) • Spanish (elementary)

TOOLS Stata, R, $\LaTeX$

Professor Matt Lowe (*Committee Chair*)
Vancouver School of Economics,
University of British Columbia
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Professor Nathan Nunn (*Committee Co-Chair*)
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REFERENCES

Professor Siwan Anderson
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University of British Columbia
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Professor Heather Sarsons
Booth School of Business
University of Chicago
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[CV compiled on 2026-07-31]